

Standard Operating Procedure

Emergency Triage and Reassessment

«Hospital Name» — Supports COP.2.d

SOP No.	[Hospital to define]	Version	1.0
Effective Date	_____	Review Frequency	Annual, or on change
Prepared By	Quality Coordinator Name: _____ Signature: _____		
Approved By	Medical Superintendent Name: _____ Signature: _____		

1. Purpose

This SOP describes how «Hospital Name» triages every emergency patient by clinical priority and reassesses them at appropriate intervals while waiting or under observation.

2. Scope

Applies to every patient presenting to the emergency area, adult and paediatric.

3. Responsibility

Triage Nurse/Doctor: assigns and documents the triage category, and monitors patients for reassessment timing while waiting.

4. Procedure

1. Assign a triage category to every patient on arrival, using the hospital's adopted triage tool (e.g. a five-level system such as the Emergency Severity Index).
2. Only qualified/trained staff perform triage — confirm training before assigning this duty.
3. Reassess patients waiting for care at an interval appropriate to their triage category — higher-acuity categories are reassessed more frequently.
4. Document every reassessment finding in the medical record, not only the initial triage category.
5. Escalate immediately if a waiting patient's condition changes or worsens, regardless of their original triage category.

5. Records

Supported by Records 9 and 10 of the COP.2 Required Records pack.

6. Related Documents

- HCO_COP_2_v2_REWRITE_DRAFT — COP.2 policy

7. Review

Reviewed annually, and immediately after any adverse event linked to a triage or reassessment delay.

8. References

- Agency for Healthcare Research and Quality. Emergency Severity Index (ESI): A Triage Tool for Emergency Departments. <https://www.ahrq.gov/patient-safety/settings/emergency-dept/esi.html> — a five-level triage algorithm the hospital may adopt or adapt as its example tool.